3. Introduction to CSF Profiles and Tiers

This section defines the concepts of CSF Profiles and Tiers.

3.1. CSF Profiles

A *CSF Organizational Profile* describes an organization's current and/or target cybersecurity posture in terms of the Core's outcomes. Organizational Profiles are used to understand, tailor, assess, prioritize, and communicate the Core's outcomes by considering an organization's mission objectives, stakeholder expectations, threat landscape, and requirements. An organization can then prioritize its actions to achieve specific outcomes and communicate that information to stakeholders.

Every Organizational Profile includes one or both of the following:

1. A *Current Profile* specifies the Core outcomes that an organization is currently achieving (or attempting to achieve) and characterizes how or to what extent each outcome is being achieved.
2. A *Target Profile* specifies the desired outcomes that an organization has selected and prioritized for achieving its cybersecurity risk management objectives. A Target Profile considers anticipated changes to the organization's cybersecurity posture, such as new requirements, new technology adoption, and threat intelligence trends.

> A *Community Profile* is a baseline of CSF outcomes that is created and published to address shared interests and goals among a number of organizations. A Community Profile is typically developed for a particular sector, subsector, technology, threat type, or other use case. An organization can use a Community Profile as the basis for its own Target Profile. Examples of Community Profiles can be found on the NIST CSF website.

The steps shown in Fig. 3 and summarized below illustrate one way that an organization could use an Organizational Profile to help inform continuous improvement of its cybersecurity.



Fig. 3. Steps for creating and using a CSF Organizational Profile